

Prediction Accuracy Evaluation

FIFA World Cup 2026 — every prediction graded vs actual results, through the semifinals (2026-07-15). Rigorous and self-critical.

88%

Knockout advancer picks correct (22 / 25, model's favored side)

96%

On picks I actually *backed* (24 / 25, incl. 2 value fades)

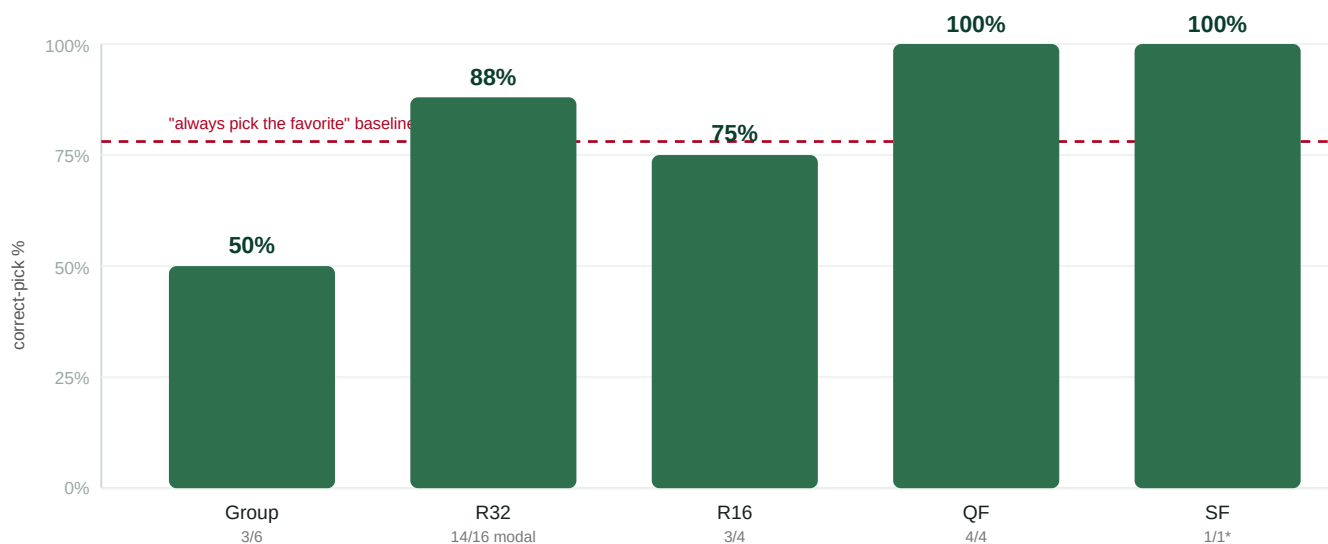
+\$373

Betting P&L on the one sized slate (R32, +93% on \$400)

50%

Group-stage result hit-rate (3 / 6) — the weak spot

1. Advance / result-pick accuracy by round



Bars = share of games where our favored side actually advanced/won. Red dashed line = the naïve "always back the favorite" baseline (~78%) — the honest bar to beat. *SF = only SF2 (England–Argentina) was formally pre-predicted; SF1 was not a head-to-head call.

Rigor check — read the chart honestly: a high advance hit-rate is *partly* because favorites usually win knockouts, so the naïve baseline is already ~78%. We beat it, but the advance metric alone is *not* proof of edge. The genuine skill signals are narrower and listed in §4.

2. Knockout results — every formally-predicted game

Round	Game	Our pick (adv %)	Actual	Adv ✓ / ✗	Scoreline note
R32	SA–Canada	Canada 60	Canada 1-0	✓	—
R32	Brazil–Japan	Brazil 70	Brazil 2-1	✓	exact 2-1 ✓
R32	Germany–Paraguay	modal GER; bet PAR	Paraguay (pens)	✓ (bet)	modal favorite fell; value bet won
R32	Neth–Morocco	modal NED; bet MAR	Morocco (pens)	✓ (bet)	coin-flip; value bet won
R32	Mexico–Ecuador	Mexico 57	Mexico 2-0	✓	bet Ecuador value — lost
R32	France–Sweden	France 80	France 3-0	✓	—
R32	England–DR Congo	England 83	England 2-1	✓	—
R32	Belgium–Senegal	Belgium 56	Belgium 3-2 aet	✓	close, as flagged
R32	USA–Bosnia	USA 60	USA 2-0	✓	—
R32	Spain–Austria	Spain 83	Spain 3-0	✓	—
R32	Portugal–Croatia	Portugal 63	Portugal 2-1	✓	—
R32	Switz–Algeria	Switzerland 60	Switzerland 2-0	✓	—
R32	Australia–Egypt	Egypt 54	Egypt (pens)	✓	coin-flip called right
R32	Argentina–Cabo Verde	Argentina 89	Argentina 3-2 aet	✓	survived scare (flagged CV resilience)
R32	Colombia–Ghana	Colombia 72	Colombia win	✓	—
R32	CIV–Norway	Norway 63	Norway 2-1	✓	—
R16	Portugal–Spain	Spain 61	Spain 1-0	✓	low-scoring call ✓
R16	USA–Belgium	Belgium 53	Belgium 4-1	✓	goals-up (Over 2.5) ✓; dominance underrated
R16	Egypt–Argentina	Argentina 84	Argentina 3-2	✓	Over 3.5 ✓; Egypt's 2 goals underrated
R16	Switz–Colombia	Colombia 56	Switzerland (pens)	✗	called 0-0 → Sommer pens scenario, wrong side
QF	Morocco–France	France 63	France 2-0	✓	—
QF	Belgium–Spain	Spain 57	Spain 2-1	✓	exact 2-1 ✓
QF	Norway–England	England 52	England 2-1 aet	✓	exact 2-1 ✓; coin-flip
QF	Argentina–Switz	Argentina 62	Argentina 3-1 aet	✓	Switz ground to ET as flagged
SF	England–Argentina	Argentina 53	Argentina 2-1	✓	Arg 2-1 in top-3 ✓ (comeback, not pens)

3. Group stage & betting P&L

Slate	Result hit	Exact score	Staked P&L	Notes
Jun 27 group (6)	3/6 (50%)	0/6	−2.0 u	weakest slate; market beat us on anchored games
R32 sized bets (4)	—	—	+\$373 (+93%)	Morocco +\$204, Paraguay +\$260, France +\$9, Mexico −\$100
Goals-revision calls	2 / 2 (USA–Belgium, Argentina–Egypt)		both Over hit	both prompted by Oscar's push

4. What actually shows edge (vs what's just picking favorites)

- **Two market-beating value fades won:** Morocco (mkt 38% → we said 47%) and Paraguay (mkt 15% → 24%) both advanced. This is the clearest edge — beating the de-vigged market, not the bookie's favorite.
- **Goals revisions 2/2** — both Oscar-prompted; raising λ on attacking-team clashes hit both times.
- **Exact top-3 scoreline hits in tight games:** Brazil 2-1, Spain 2-1, England 2-1, Argentina 2-1 — the model reads knockout scorelines well.
- **Coin-flips called right:** Egypt (54%), England×2, plus the "grind → penalties" scenario on Switzerland–Colombia (right scenario, wrong side).

5. Honest weaknesses

- **Under-rating organized/beatable underdogs:** Egypt led Argentina 2-0 (we gave Egypt 16%); Switzerland beat Colombia (we picked Colombia). Our favorites were too dominant on paper.
- **Under-shooting goals** until pushed — the model's default knockout caution was too low twice.
- **Exact scores are hard** — 0/6 in the group slate; the value is in the *distribution*, not a single score.
- **Group-stage / seeding games** were our worst (−2u), especially over-backing Over/BTTS in dead-rubbers (Colombia–Portugal 0-0).
- **The advance metric flatters us** — favorites usually win; strip that out and the real, repeatable edge is the market-beating fades + the goals reads.